called “enlightened” Muslims’, who ‘have gone to the extent of preaching “tolerance” to their brethren in faith’.

The election or nomination of competent authority to interpret the ecclesiastical law under modern conditions will be no easy matter, and it is well known that even the pious and the orthodox often disagree among themselves. Orthodoxy ultimately becomes one’s own doxy, and the other person’s doxy is heterodoxy.

If such an authority is established it will deal presumably with the Muslims alone. But Islam is a proselytizing religion and questions touching other faiths will frequently arise. Even now doubtful cases arise, especially relating to girls and women who, with little thought of religion, marry a Muslim or elope with him or are abducted by him. If they slide back from the strict path of the faith, are they to be subjected to the terrible punishment for apostasy?

In the purely religious sphere then we might have, if Sir Mohamad’s suggestions were carried out, ‘the institution of a kind of Inquisition with heresy hunts, excommunication, punishment for apostasy, and a general suppression of so-called “enlightened Muslims” and a prohibition of the practice or teaching of “tolerance”’. Other spheres of life would be equally affected for Islam and Hinduism do not believe in confining themselves to Sunday observance. They are weekday religions invading every department of life.

The next step is obviously one of full application of the personal law in strict accordance with the ancient texts. In theory, this personal law is still applied both to Hindus and Muslims in the British courts, but in practice many changes have crept in. The criminal law at present prevailing in the country has very little or perhaps nothing to do with the old Muslim or Hindu codes. In civil law, the divergence is not marked and inheritance, marriage, divorce, adoption, etc., are supposed to be according to the old directions. But even here some changes have crept in and attempts are constantly being made to widen their range (civil marriage, divorce among Hindus, Sarda Act, etc.). In regard to inheritance, there is a very curious Oudh Estate Act affecting the Oudh taluqadars, which lays down a peculiar